

Trainee Worksheet 2

Front Desk Communication Beyond Basics

In this session you will use English for realistic front desk tasks: receiving visitors, checking appointments, giving directions and solving small problems.

Work actively with your partner or group. Use the language bank when you need help.

Task 1 – Good receptionist or poor receptionist?

Work with a partner. Write G (good) or P (poor). Then improve the poor examples.

Behaviour / phrase	G / P	Better version
"How can I help you?"		
"Wait."		
Checking the appointment schedule before answering		
"What do you want?"		
"Please take a seat."		
Asking the visitor to spell their surname		

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Task 2 – Front desk language bank

Read the language below. Highlight the expressions you think will be most useful today.

A. Greeting and checking	B. Solving small problems
• Good morning. How can I help you?	• Just a moment, please.
• Could you tell me your name, please?	• Please take a seat.
• Who are you here to see?	• Let me check the schedule.
• Do you have an appointment?	• I'm sorry, she's in a meeting at the moment.
• What time is your appointment?	• I can't find your name on the list.
• Could you spell your surname, please?	• The meeting has been delayed.
C. Giving directions: Go to the first floor. / Take the lift on your left. / Turn right at the corridor. / It's next to the meeting room. / It's at the end of the corridor.	

Task 3 – Visitor check-in with schedule

Student A is the receptionist. Student B is the visitor. Use the schedule below and complete the visitor log.

Time	Visitor / Company	Person to see	Department / Room
09:30	Marta Silva – Bright Office	Ms Costa	HR – Room 12
10:00	Paulo Freitas – Orion Print	Mr Green	Finance – Room 24
10:30	Ana Melo – Delta Services	Ms Lopes	Admin – Room 18
11:00	Rui Santos – City Supplies	Mr Nunes	Purchasing – Room 21

Student A – Receptionist Use these prompts: - Greet the visitor. - Ask who the visitor wants to see. - Ask if there is an appointment. - Check the time on the schedule. - Confirm the department / room OR explain the problem. - Ask the visitor to wait or give directions.	Student B – Visitor Choose one situation card: - You have an appointment with Ms Costa at 09:30. - You are here to deliver documents for Finance. - You want to speak to Mr Nunes, but you are one hour early. - You are looking for Ms Lopes, but you are not sure about the department.
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Visitor log

Visitor name	
Company	
Person to see	
Appointment time	
Reason for visit	
Action taken	

Task 4 – Directions inside the building

Work in pairs. Student A asks for a place. Student B gives directions using the building plan.

SECOND FLOOR	Room 21 Purchasing	Room 24 Finance	Meeting Room B
FIRST FLOOR	Room 12 HR	Room 18 Admin	Manager's Office
GROUND FLOOR	Reception	Training Room	Photocopy Room
Useful direction language	Take the lift / stairs.	Turn left / right.	It's next to / opposite / at the end of the corridor.

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Ask for these places	Tick when you can do it
• HR office	☐
• Finance department	☐
• Meeting Room B	☐
• Manager's Office	☐
• Training Room	☐
• Photocopy Room	☐

Task 5 – Problem cards at reception

Pick one problem card. Role-play the situation and decide what the receptionist should do.

The visitor has no appointment, but wants to speak to Mr Green.	The visitor is in the wrong department.
The person the visitor wants to see is in a meeting.	The appointment has been delayed by 20 minutes.

Useful support: I'm sorry, but... / Let me check. / Could you wait a few minutes, please?
 / You may need to go to... / Would you like to leave a message?

Task 6 – Read, check and act

Read the information below and answer the questions.

Reception note Visitor: Marta Silva Company: Bright Office Appointment: 09:30 with Ms Costa Department: HR – Room 12 Problem: Visitor arrived at 09:00	Daily update Ms Costa is delayed until 09:45. Finance has moved to Room 26 today. The lift is out of order. Visitors must sign in at reception.
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Question	Answer
What time did the visitor arrive?	
Who is the visitor here to see?	
What should the receptionist say about the delay?	
Where should Finance visitors go today?	
How can a visitor go upstairs if the lift is out of order?	

Task 7 – Final mini-simulation

Work in pairs. Choose one final scenario. Act it out. Then swap roles.

A visitor from Beta Supplies arrives for a meeting with Ms Costa at 10:30, but she is delayed. Ask the visitor to wait.	A visitor wants to go to Finance, but today Finance is in Room 26. Give directions.
A visitor wants to speak to Mr Green, but has no appointment. Ask questions and offer a solution.	A visitor has the right person but the wrong floor. Check the schedule and help.

My reflection

Today I can...	
One useful phrase I learned is...	
I still need help with...	
My speaking confidence today was...	